

CHANDIGARH | Dangerous Portent

MUMBAI | Baby Talk

Maharashtra's Wardha district is monitoring its babies—even before they're born. Under the National Rural Health Mission's *Jeevandaine* project, 990 villages are involved in an SMS-based system to create a database of pregnancies. Auxiliary Nurse Midwives (ANMS) alert the Wardha Zila Parishad about new pregnancies through an SMS. The system calculates important dates of the pregnancy and SMS



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alerts are then sent to the ANMS to check on expectant mothers during their pregnancy. After birth, details of the child are fed into the database and reminders are sent about immunisation. Dr Arun Amle, district health officer, Wardha, says, "We can easily monitor pregnancies now, especially high risk ones and provide adequate medical attention." *by Nishat Bari*

wanted by both the Punjab and Haryana Police for his suspected involvement in terror cases. The 35-year-old is believed to have masterminded the attack on Dera Sacha Sauda chief Gurmeet Ram Rahim in February 2008. His arrest led to the recovery of 2.3 kg of RDX and a .30-calibre pistol. Clearly, Baba had a vast range of terror on his mind. Initial investigations have revealed that after the attack on Rahim, Baba fled to Pakistan via Malaysia. Incidentally, just a day

before the police announced Baba's arrest, the Mohali Police also nabbed a Lahore-based ISI agent, 28-year-old Irfan Ulla, near Chandigarh and recovered a Chinese pistol, maps and photographs from him. Links between Baba and Irfan are being probed.

by Arvind Chhabra

The Punjab Police don't know whether the mood of the moment is celebration or anxiety. The arrest of Bakshish Singh alias Baba, a dreaded Khalistan Liberation Force militant is the cause of the confusion. Baba was carrying a reward of Rs 6 lakh and was



The BJP's national convention on good governance in Mumbai on June 5-6, to be addressed by Advani, Gadkari and Modi, has insiders sniggering that with no 'raj' in sight, the party can now talk about 'suraj sankalp'.

DELHI | Urban Samurais

The CRPF has begun kitting its men for the biggest threat currently facing them in Srinagar: brickbats. Stone pelting mobs have been venting their fury at security personnel, especially the CRPF, in the city. The old cane shields, helmets and padded jackets, endemic to riot police since Independence, were proving ineffective. Injured personnel meant the possibility of retaliation from their colleagues. "We decided to upgrade our riot gear to protect our personnel," says CRPF Director-General Vikram Srivastava. Since last month, the force has issued at least 300 sets comprising



CRPF MEN IN THEIR NEW PROTECTIVE GEAR

fibreglass shields, canes and full body protection which makes personnel resemble Samurai warriors. More such equipment is on its way for the keepers of the law.

by Sandeep Unnithan